ORIENTATION

ACTIVITY:
FLIPPING OFF CEREMONY

FACILITATION GUIDE ▶▶

Participants have called in, left voicemails, signed up, showed up, and now ... Orientation meetup is all about building a doorway in time and walking through it together. Month Offline has officially™ begun! The focus is *not* on the pain of the problem, but on the fun of the challenge ahead. Private commitments become shared, and participants get a chance to meet the rest of the cohort.

PREVIOUSLY:
PRE-ORIENTATION

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NEXT:
COMMUNICATION

FOLD 2

PRO*TIPS

Collect ur participants' Time Capsule cards before handing out the Offline Pledges. Take them home with u and review to get to know ur ppl better. Bring them back on the last week to show how far they've come.

WHAT 2 BRING

DON'T FORGET!

- Every week: name tags, hand bell, crayons, & pens
- Time Capsule cards, Offline Pledges, welcome postcards
- Internet stickers and (optional) bedazzling sickers
- challenge #1: pen pal stationary
- extra credit: pre-stamped envelopes [link]

FOLD 1

✻ EVENT SCORE — MEETUP #1

TIME	FACILITATOR	ACTIVITY
START		**WELCOME** ppl at the front with name tags, welcome postcards [link], and Time Capsule card* [link]: pair up, ask each other questions, record partner's answers
		facilitators ring the bell, welcome full group to the challenge, share their Month Offline origin story
+20MIN		**ROUND ROBIN**: prompt #1 (full group): What's the story of your name? * prompt #2 (4-5 ppl shout out answers): What's a digital habit you're letting go of?
+50MIN		**FLIPPING OFF:** ask participants to hold up their smartphones, repeat a few things ppl are letting go of, have ppl turn off phones in 3, 2, 1 ... then hold up flip phones, repeat a few things ppl are inviting in, and slam phones shut
+1H0MIN		**PLEDGE**: collect time capsule, hand out Pledges, ask volunteer to read b4 all sign
		MO 101: 1) share structure: weekly theme + challenge * 2) introduce internet sticker * 3) hand out pen pal stationary [link] and ask someone to read THE REWIND aloud
		dumbphone 101: 1) add facilitator as new contact * 2) snap first photo
+1H15MIN		**BREAKOUTS:** 1) peer2peer tech support * 2) bedazzling stickers for decorating * 3) discuss weekly challenge (letter writing practices, pen pals, fav communication)

MEETUP #2

ACTIVITY:
OPEN QUESTIONS ONLY

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Participants are settling into their dumbed down life after the first week of Month Offline. Now that they've taken the leap and their initial fears are behind them, it's time to help them learn from each other's problems and resolutions. Participants will be intro'd to their flipmates, a small group that supports them thru the challenge. We also introduce dumb prompts: weekly conversation + drawing exercises that allow us to create analog "social media" posts.

PREVIOUSLY:
COMMUNICATION

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NEXT:
MEMORY

FOLD 2

PRO*TIPS

Heads Up is a mini-game for ppl to discover shared interests. Facilitator asks everyone to close their eyes (like in Mafia) & says "wake up if you want to ____". use responses from Time Capsule cards to fill in the blank. ppl who have this in common see each other. repeat 4-5x.

WHAT 2 BRING

DON'T FORGET!

- Flipmate Card Deck
- Offtime Outlet Inventory
- challenge #2: Shotlist for photo scavenger hunt
- have participants bring the meaningful object they wrote about
- extra credit: disposable cameras (link)

FOLD 1

✻ EVENT SCORE — MEETUP #2

TIME	FACILITATOR	ACTIVITY
START		**WELCOME** with name tags and dumb prompts, invite ppl to pair up and chat
+15MIN		share drawing prompt: a moment of friction from first week on dumbphone
+20MIN		**ROUND ROBIN:** welcome ppl to Meetup #2, recap Meetup #1, have new ppl introduce themselves
		prompt (full group): what is the object you wrote about to your pen pal (or are planning to write about)?
		Play Heads Up* w/ info from Time Capsule
+50MIN		**OFFTIME OUTLETS:** collect dumb drawings, have ppl pick a flipmate card at random
		ask ppl to sit with group, share purpose of flipmates, add each other's numbers
		introduce Offtime Outlets and Show & Tell
		OPEN QUESTIONS ONLY: ppl interview each other about potential Offtime Outlets * switch mates after 5 minutes
+1H10MIN		**WEEKLY CHALLENGE:** hand out shotlist challenge (link), introduce Memory theme, ask someone to read THE REWIND aloud
+1H15MIN		**BREAKOUTS:** 1) peer2peer tech support * 2) Offtime Outlet signup, record projects on inventory sheet * 3) discuss weekly challenge (photo practices, cameras, etc)

MEETUP #3

ACTIVITY:
STORY LINES

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With offtime outlets and the MO Show & Tell on the table, participants are hopefully thinking more expansively about what their Month Offline is *for*. This meetup is about helping people learn more about each other by hearing the stories of where they are coming from (literally). "We are where we go." We'll reflect on how the dumbphone can free our attention to practice the art of noticing our surroundings.

PREVIOUSLY:
MEMORY

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NEXT:
NAVIGATION

FOLD 2

PRO*TIPS

Challenge ppl to go the whole week without using the Maps app on their dumbphone (print directions or write them down)

WHAT 2 BRING

DON'T FORGET!

- Paper maps of ur city (from library, welcome center, or Rand McNally)
- challenge #3: cartography card for subjective mapping
- Offtime Outlet inventory for ppl to revisit & discuss projects
- extra credit: compasses [link]

FOLD 1

* EVENT SCORE — MEETUP #3

TIME	FACILITATOR	ACTIVITY
START		**WELCOME** with name tags and dumb prompts, invite ppl to pair up and chat
+15MIN		share drawing prompt: a favorite photo you snapped this week
+20MIN		**ROUND ROBIN:** welcome ppl to Meetup #3, recap Meetup #2, introduce any new ppl
		prompt (full group): share a favorite photo from the week or something new you noticed * small groups: share the gallery you visited or want to visit w/ flipmates
+45MIN		**WEEKLY CHALLENGE:** hand out Cartography Card [link], introduce Navigation theme, ask someone to read THE REWIND aloud
		collect dumb drawings, ask ppl to get in flipmate groups, & give 1 map per group
		STORY LINES: Locate venue and draw a star * Pass around the marker and tell the story of how you got here today and what you noticed along the way * Draw your commute line to the star * Share what you've learned about navigating on dumbphone
+1H15MIN		**BREAKOUTS:** 1) Offtime Outlets: let ppl update their inventory entry and share any project developments, get support * 2) discuss weekly challenge (how your city streets are laid out, favorite local spots, subjective mapping, subjective mapping, etc)

MEETUP #4

ACTIVITY:
COLLAGE COMPETITION

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With only one more week of Month Offline to go, it's time to introduce a bit of competition. Participants will choose their own adventure, meditation or recreation, and form 2 teams. Though playful, the Boredom week addresses a deep question: how to stare into the attentional abyss without losing our wits? This meetup opens up a rare conversation about the ways we fill the idle in-betweens.

PREVIOUSLY:
NAVIGATION

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NEXT:
BOREDOM

IS MO * MONTH OFFLINE * LESS IS MO * MONTH OFFLINE * LESS IS

* IS MO * MONTH OFFLINE * LESS IS MO * MONTH OFFLINE * LESS I

FOLD 2

PRO*TIPS

Invite external friend(s) or alumni to be the (impartial) collage competition judge -- this is a fun way to expand the circle of ppl you're including in the meetups. Put teams in group chats to help them coordinate their outings.

WHAT 2 BRING

DON'T FORGET!

- Old magazines, scissors, and glue sticks for collaging
- Poster board or cardboard for glueing collages
- Candy or other prize for winning team
- challenge #4: boredom bingo
- extra credit: focus beads [link]

FOLD 1

* EVENT SCORE — MEETUP #4

TIME	FACILITATOR	ACTIVITY
START		**WELCOME** with name tags and dumb prompts, invite ppl to pair up and chat
+15MIN		share drawing prompt: draw a favorite location from your map or neighborhood
+20MIN		**ROUND ROBIN:** welcome ppl to Meetup #4, recap Meetup #3, introduce any new ppl
		prompt (full group): share point of interest on map * small groups: something you noticed in transit or added to notebook
+45MIN		**WEEKLY CHALLENGE:** collect dumb drawings, ask each person to choose Team Meditation (RED) or Recreation (BLUE), and hand them Boredom Bingo card [link]
		Ask ppl to sit with team, read THE REWIND aloud, hand out magazines & scissors
+50MIN		**COLLAGE COMPETITION:** Create a team vision board for your week of Meditation/ Recreation * team prompt: share about a favorite meditation or recreation outlet
		Teams present collages to judge(s)*
		Ask teams to discuss where they want to go for their meditative/recreative outing while judges select winner
+1H15MIN		**BREAKOUTS:** 1) Offtime Outlets: ppl share developments and get support * 2) discuss weekly challenge

GRADUATION

ACTIVITY:
COMMENCEMENT TOASTS

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It's graduation time! This week is all about reflecting back on the Month Offline and looking forward to the post-challenge future. The important thing is to celebrate participants whether or not they are keeping their dumbphone going forward. The 30 days gave everyone a contrast experience: the chance to turn off auto-pilot and challenge the assumptions + habits of the dominant technoculture.

PREVIOUSLY:
BOREDOM

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NEXT:
SHOW & TELL

FOLD 2

PRO*TIPS

Whoever receives the most stickers during the Who Among Us game is the MVP of the entire Month Offline challenge -- gift them bubbles or something playful! ... Consider creating an alumni listserv and adding ppl post-grad.

WHAT 2 BRING

DON'T FORGET!

- Certificates of Completion
- Time Capsule cards from orientation week
- Stickers for Who Among Us game
- Prizes for team MVPS (e.g. chalk for recreation, incense for meditation)
- Blank postcards for writing to future cohort

FOLD 1

✻ EVENT SCORE — MEETUP #5

TIME	FACILITATOR	ACTIVITY
START		**WELCOME** with name tags and dumb prompts, invite ppl to pair up and chat with someone from the opposite team
+15MIN		Share drawing prompt: something that reminds you of inner peace / inner child
+20MIN		Welcome ppl to Graduation and congratulate them on making it to the finish line
		WHO AMONG US: call out achievements saying "who among us ..."* talked to a stranger, cold called somebody, got genuinely lost, etc. * ppl raise their hand if it applies to them, and receive a sticker
		Teams share about their outings, nominate MVPs, and receive prizes
		Collect dumb drawings, return Time Capsule cards, review what changed
+30MIN		**GRADUATION:** Each participant stands at podium to share a toast: "What's one learning you're taking with you?"
		Sign completion certificate, take graduation photo, participant rings bell
+1H15MIN		**FEEDFWD:** hand out feedfwd cards and ask ppl to help us improve for the next round
		BREAKOUTS: 1) invite ppl to write postcard to future cohort (link) * 2) discuss Show & Tell plans